

May 06, 2026

Ordering Provider: Dr. Sarah Chen, Internal Medicine
NPI: 1234567890

Patient: Jordan Avery | DOB: 03/12/1968 | Sex: F
Payer: United Healthcare | Plan: Choice Plus | Member ID: UHC9JA00142

REQUESTED PROCEDURE(S)

CPT 70450 [PRIMARY] - Computed tomography, head or brain; without contrast material

MEDICAL NECESSITY NARRATIVE

Jordan A. presents with a new-onset thunderclap headache that reached maximal intensity within seconds, accompanied by photophobia and no prior headache history -- a classic presentation requiring urgent CT head (CPT 70450) to rule out subarachnoid hemorrhage. A complete neurological examination including cranial nerves II-XII, motor strength, sensation, and coordination was documented and is intact. Medical necessity is supported by three fully satisfied policy criteria, including the presence of red flag neurological symptoms and a neurological exam that will directly inform emergent management.

Submitted by: Dr. Sarah Chen, Internal Medicine
NPI: 1234567890
Date: May 06, 2026

Provider Signature

AUTHORIZATION CRITERIA CHECKLIST

Patient: Jordan A. | Payer: United Healthcare | Date: May 06, 2026

1. New or worsening headache pattern with documented clinical characteristics (onset, quality, severity, associated symptoms)

Rationale: 3-day history of new-onset severe headache described as the worst headache of my life with no prior similar episodes -- a new headache pattern with thunderclap onset quality.

Evidence: "New-onset severe headache for 3 days. Described by patient as the worst headache of my life. Thunderclap in quality. No prior history of similar headache episodes."

2. At least one red-flag feature: thunderclap onset, worst headache of life, fever with meningismus, new neurological deficit, or headache in immunocompromised patient

Rationale: Thunderclap onset (maximal intensity within seconds), photophobia, phonophobia, and worst-ever headache presentation documented -- classic red flag features requiring urgent imaging.

Evidence: "Red flags: thunderclap onset reaching maximal intensity in seconds, new worst-ever headache pattern, photophobia, no prior headache history, failure to respond to analgesics."

3. Neurological examination performed and documented prior to imaging order

Rationale: Complete neurological exam documented: cranial nerves II-XII, motor strength 5/5 bilaterally, sensation, coordination, and reflexes.

Evidence: "Cranial nerves: II-XII intact. Motor: 5/5 strength bilaterally. Sensation: Intact. Coordination: Finger-nose-finger and heel-shin intact."